

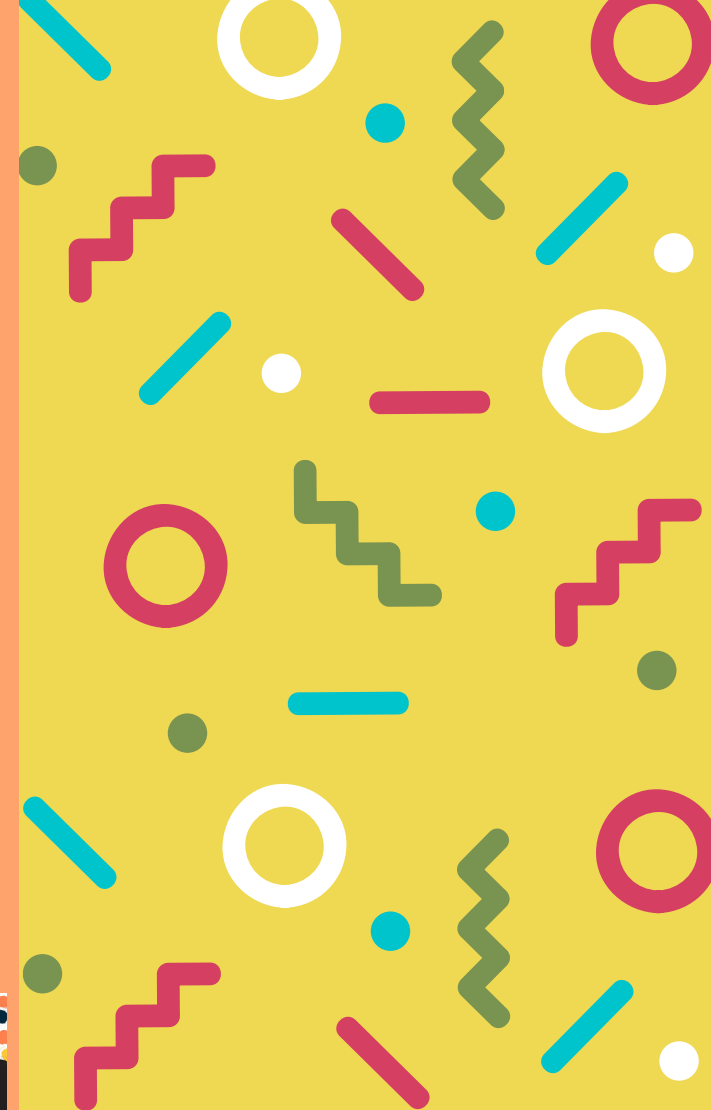
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PERSONALITY

Personality is defined as the characteristic sets of behaviours, thoughts and emotional patterns of an individual that make them unique.



PSYCHOLOGICAL

Personality Theories

PSYCHOLOGY ASSESSMENT 2020

By Kaelyn Trompeter

THE HISTORY OF PERSONALITY

HIPPOCRATES:

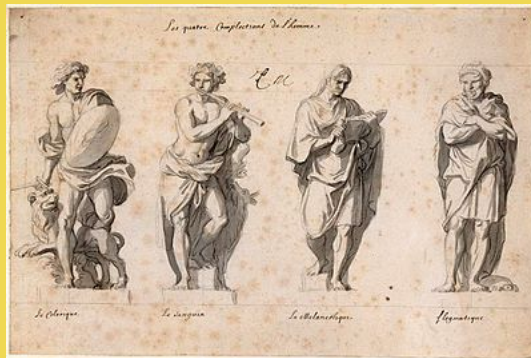
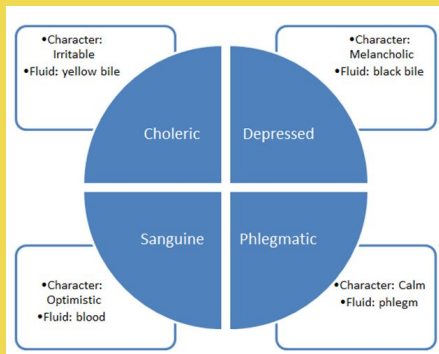
The earliest exploration into personality began in 370 BC in

Ancient Greece, discovered by Hippocrates, who proposed that there are two

pillars to temperament. In this, he established the Four Humours – melancholic

(depressed), choleric (irritable), phlegmatic (slow), and sanguine (cheerful).

Hippocrates believed that each body contained these four fluids, for which personality was derived from which one was most dominant.



WILLIAM SHELDON (1940s)

More recent studies by the works of William Sheldon, in the 1940s, aimed to examine the relationship between body build and personality. In this, he identified three main body types: endomorph, mesomorph, and ectomorph. He categorized endomorph participants, as those of a

large, over-weight build, as being cheerful, sociable, and carefree, whereas mesomorphs, those of athletic builds, as being assertive and courageous. He saw that ectomorphs, those with a thin, slender build, as being introverted and artistic.



PLATO & ARISTOTLE

The ancient explorations of Hippocrates fuelled the

categorical way of understanding personality. This is highlighted in the works of Plato who influenced the four groupings of personality: artistic, sensible, intuitive, and reasoning. Similar working can be seen by Aristotle who hypothesized the four factors: iconic (artistic), noetic (intuition), dianoetic (logic), and pistic (common sense).

History of Personality Tests:



History of the first personality test began with Woodworth Personal Data Sheet in 1919, created to aid in the selection processing of US army recruits with susceptible shell shock. Amongst the same time, Freud introduced the method of Psychoanalysis in which aimed to investigate the unconscious motives of humans, as to show whether a person's thoughts and emotions had an underlying sexual motive.

Testing involved patients revealing their repressed thoughts and experiences to the physician, in which were then interpreted by Freud. Though his method never entered mainstream psychological therapies, it played a role into the more popularised personality testings such as the Rorschach Ink Blot Test (1921) and the Thematic Apperception test (1935).



MASLOW'S HUMANISTIC THEORY



Abraham Maslow was an American Psychologist, best known for his contributions to the Humanistic Theory of Personality. His approach to this study was centred mainly around the concept of free-will and subjective experiences. His sole interest was an individual's innate drive to self-actualisation – an instance where one becomes everything that they are capable of, reaching full potential. Though his research was rejected by mainstream psychology and scientific method due to limited understanding of human nature, Maslow aimed to celebrate what it meant to be human. His studies began focusing on the lives of successful candidates such as Abraham Lincoln or George Washington, both very successful people who share similar characteristics.

TESTING PERSONALITY

Testing the Humanistic Theory is typically done through a method called a Q-sort – a systematic method studying participant perspective of their subjective experiences. The method takes a holistic approach by focusing on the individual self. This method works by providing participants with a series of cards that they would arrange in a way that represents their ideal self. The professional involved would then analyse the participant's responses through factor analysis to allow the physician to provide the participant with tips or advice on the necessary environment required to achieve their ideal self. Results would then be compared to results over time and track the individual's progress.

PARTICIPANT CODE: DR (H0000000)									
<< Most disagree		Neutral						Most agree >>	
-4	-3	-2	-1	0	+1	+2	+3	+4	
125. I believe only people who are able to control their emotions can be successful in life.	126. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	127. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	128. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	129. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	130. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	131. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	132. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	133. I believe that a person who is not able to control their emotions is a failure.	
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Additional Comments:									

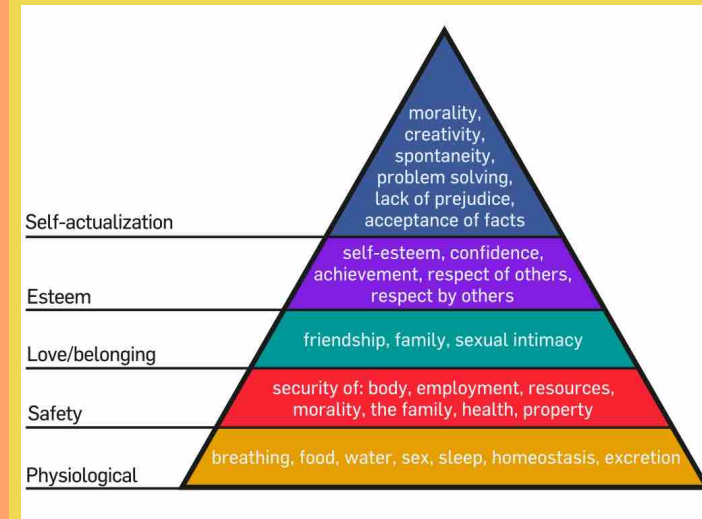
STRENGTHS

- Maslow's theory is commended for its simple understanding of human behaviour and motivation: it's easy to follow and be interpreted by most people.
- It centres the focus of personality on the whole individual not just the unconscious or genetic motives behind personality.
- His study also considers the cross-cultural aspect of how people value self-fulfilment, as well as considering basic human behaviour.

LIMITATIONS

- His study has been criticized for lacking scientific rigour due to a lack of empirical evidence regarding behaviour.
- As it is investigation one's own experiences and thoughts, data is highly subjective, for which cannot be generalised.
- His study is also found to be ethnocentric, biased towards Western Culture values and ideologies, as perceptions of self-esteem, success and self-actualization differ cross culturally; can not be applied universally.
- His study also involved the understanding that people are inherently good, which is considered to be an unrealistic concept.

Through this, he developed Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs: a level-based structure of different needs that a person must satisfy, ranging from physiological, to safety, love and belonging, to self-esteem, all in which to be met before achieving self-actualisation. He believed to achieve higher level needs; we would need to satisfy lower-level needs beforehand. His theory suggests that motivation increases as needs become met, for which one is more motivated to achieve self-actualisation. However, an individual may suffer deficiency needs in which motivation to full potential decreases as more needs become unmet.



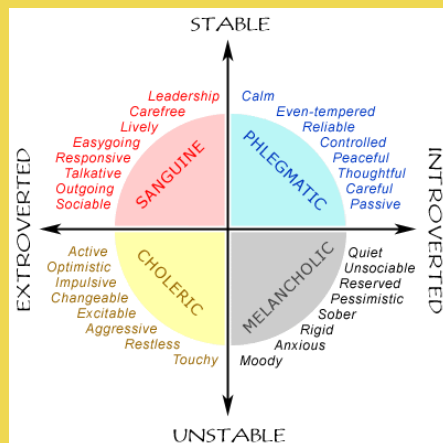
Maslow perceived those who have achieved full potential (self-actualisers) as supreme achievers of the human race. Through his studies of those considered successful, he saw that they each pursued certain traits. He saw that they fulfilled enjoyment in intimate relationships, have an accurate perception of the world and others, as well as acting independently within a society, non-conforming to the world.

EYSENCK'S SUPERTRAITS

Extroversion – Introversion: He saw that those who scored highly in extroversion, appear to be more outgoing and sociable. Those who scored low in extroversion are considered to be more introverted for which is characterized as being socially inhibited, shy and calm.

Neuroticism – Emotional stability: He defined that those who scored highly in neuroticism display more emotional instability for which are more prone to depression, anxiety as well as being more restless and moodier. Those who score low in neuroticism are more emotionally stable, obtain leadership qualities, calm and expresses a more relaxed demeanour.

Psychoticism – Impulse control: Eysenck believed that those who scored highly in psychoticism appear to be more aggressive, egocentric, impulsive and to express a tendency towards displaying anti-social behaviour. Those who score low in Psychoticism have a stronger impulse control in which individuals are more empathetic and able to better control their impulses.



TESTING PERSONALITY

As Eysenck believed that personality could be measured, testing for traits was designed through quantifiable methods such as a self-report survey. This particular personality questionnaire was designed using a Likert-scale in which the participant would respond to a statement on a scale of strongly disagree to strongly agree. This developed into the Eysenck Personality Inventory (EPI) that measure the two trait dimensions Extroversion-Introversion and Neuroticism- Emotional instability. More modernized testing methods include the dimension of Psychoticism-Impulse control. Participants would be required to answer a series of questions according to the Likert Scale. These self-report surveys generally express internal validity in questions. Once completed, results are then calculated, and participants receive a percentage score in each trait.

1) I respect authority.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

2) I know how to get people to have fun.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

3) I enjoy social gatherings.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

4) I have no trouble approaching people.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

5) I tend to brood on past mistakes.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

6) I tend to be nervous.
Very Inaccurate ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Very Accurate

STRENGTHS

- Eysenck's study takes into account both an individual's nature and nurture, arguing strongly that biological components influence personality combined with socialization during childhood that can establish one's personality. This makes this study more valid as it is incorporating both genetic and social components, rather than one.
- Considered to be more empirically verifiable than most psychological theories.
- One of the first studies to take a quantifiable approach to measuring personality, as well as being able to assess the heritability of personality traits.

LIMITATIONS

- Considered to be too fixed; doesn't consider how individuals vary amongst traits for which cannot explain how or why personality changes due to these fixed trait dimensions.
- Results are highly subjective due to the self-report questionnaire; considered unreliable.
- Falls victim to the Barnum Effect, in which interpretation of these traits are too broad, lacking situational consistency in individuals.

EYSENCK'S TRAIT THEORY



Hans Eysenck was a German-born psychologist best known for his contribution to the studies of intelligence and personality. During the time of World War II, Eysenck worked in England in the Emergency hospital, aiding in psychiatric treatment where he became sceptical about uses of psychoanalysis, specifically in clinical cases. Eysenck's finding became popularised in 1963 in his trait theory of personality that focused solely on the biological basis of personality. He believed that our personality is determined by our nature (genetic composition), that certain genetic traits are the foundation of personality. By combining his experience in clinical psychology with experimental psychology, he worked to develop the Two-Factor Theory for which he analysed the way people answered personality questionnaires. With those responses, factorial analysis worked to reduce behaviours in a series of factors that held a common attribute. This formulated is known as the Supertraits, or PEN Model.